EK-03 Risk Analysis, Reviews and Proposal Quality: EVA-006, EVA-007, QUA-004 to QUA-006

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1. Document metadata

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Main topics	Proposal risk; Fairness; False positives; Uncertainty statements; Client judgement; Proposal quality; Completeness checklist; Review interpretation; Reputation score; Bias; Small samples; Delivery reliability; Milestones; Deadline performance
Relevant skills and technologies	Risk analysis; Proposal evaluation; Reviews; Project delivery; Professional conduct
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Purpose and scope: this PDF consolidates 5 source documents (EVA-006 to QUA-006). Each source keeps its own ID in every section heading, so chunks stay attributable, for example [DOC:EVA-006/...].

2. Executive summary

A risk indicator is a reason for the client to look more closely, not a finding of fault. Risks are grouped into budget, deadline, requirement and evidence categories, presented with uncertainty statements, and never based on protected or irrelevant personal characteristics. Proposal quality is measured by an 8-item completeness checklist covering scope, exclusions, testing, handover, milestones, assumptions, portfolio evidence and risks. It is an indicator and flag source, not part of the default 100-point score. This PDF contains 5 source documents in total.

3. EVA-006: EVA-006 Proposal Risk and Fairness Methodology

Source document ID: EVA-006 | Data status: Factual methodology (illustrative default parameters) with hypothetical worked examples

Purpose and scope: define risk indicators for proposals, how to distinguish risk signals from proof of failure or misconduct, how to treat missing information and how to keep comparisons fair.

EVA-006 executive summary

A risk indicator is a reason for the client to look more closely, not a finding of fault. Risks are grouped into budget, deadline, requirement and evidence categories, presented with uncertainty statements, and never based on protected or irrelevant personal characteristics.

EVA-006 - Risk indicators

Category	Indicator	Severity (illustrative)
Budget	Price below 60% of preferred maximum	Medium
Budget	Adjusted price above hard limit	Blocking
Budget	Upfront payment above 50%	Medium
Budget	Excluded scope not priced	Medium
Deadline	Duration beyond hard deadline	Blocking
Deadline	Capacity below 80% of effort	High
Deadline	Duration below 60% of reference	Medium
Deadline	Committed hours above stated availability	Medium
Requirement	Mandatory skill without direct evidence	High (hold pending evidence)
Requirement	Proposal ignores a stated requirement	Medium
Evidence	Skill only claimed	Low to medium
Evidence	Few reviews or records	Low
Evidence	Conflicting profile and case study	Medium

EVA-006 - Risk signal versus proof

A risk signal means a pattern that often accompanies problems. It is not proof that the freelancer will fail or that misconduct occurred. The assistant uses wording such as 'this proposal shows a capacity risk' and never 'this freelancer is dishonest' or 'will miss the deadline'.

EVA-006 - Treatment of missing information

- Missing information is reported as missing and may lower confidence, but it is not treated as a negative fact.
- A freelancer with no reviews is not rated negatively (QUA-004).
- A skill without evidence is described as 'no evidence found', not 'lacks the skill'.
- The assistant suggests what the client can ask for: a code sample, a milestone plan, a reference.

EVA-006 - Fairness rules

- Do not use protected or irrelevant characteristics such as nationality, gender, age, religion, ethnicity, appearance, accent, disability or family status.
- Use the same criteria and the same formulas for every proposal in a job.
- Time-zone overlap may be used only when the client states a required overlap as a requirement.
- Do not reward or penalize the style of writing of a proposal as such; evaluate stated scope and evidence.
- Report when two proposals have scores so close that the difference is within the uncertainty of the data.

EVA-006 - Examples of false positives (fictional)

Signal	Why it may be a false positive	Appropriate handling
Low price flagged for a small, well-scoped job	Scope may genuinely be small	Ask client to confirm scope; do not reject
Late delivery history on PRJ-002	Client changed the escrow rules (QUA-005)	Mention context; do not lower a score by itself
Only one project in the domain	Highly relevant project can still show strong skill	State limited evidence; show the project
Hold pending evidence for Kubernetes	Evidence may exist outside the knowledge base	Invite the freelancer to provide evidence

EVA-006 - Appropriate uncertainty statements

- 'The knowledge base contains 3 reviews for FRE-002, so the reputation score has limited reliability.'
- 'No evidence of Kubernetes experience was found for FRE-001; the profile claims it but no project supports it.'
- 'The deadline score could not check feasibility because the job has no effort estimate.'
- 'Scores differ by 1.2 points; treat these two proposals as comparable.'

EVA-006 - Supporting client judgement

The recommendation supports, and does not replace, client judgement. The client may weigh factors the system cannot see: communication style in an interview, team fit, long-term relationship, or business priorities. The interface should show the score, the evidence and the flags, and let the client override rankings and weights. The assistant must not pressure the client to choose the top-ranked proposal.

EVA-006 - Audit and consistency checks

Log inputs, formulas, weights and retrieved sources for every recommendation. Periodically compare recommendations across groups of freelancers for unexplained differences, and review chunks that cause consistent disagreement between retrieval and database values.

EVA-006 - Summary of key findings

- Risk signals prompt review; they do not prove failure or misconduct.
- Missing information lowers confidence, not scores unfairly.
- Protected and irrelevant characteristics are excluded.
- Recommendations support client judgement.

EVA-006 - Keywords and alternative terminology

proposal risk; fairness; bias; false positive; risk indicator; uncertainty; missing information; protected characteristics; client judgement; explainability; audit

4. EVA-007: EVA-007 Proposal Quality Criteria

Source document ID: EVA-007 | Data status: Factual methodology (illustrative defaults) with computed examples

Purpose and scope: define how to judge the completeness and checkability of a freelancer proposal.

EVA-007 executive summary

Proposal quality is measured by an 8-item completeness checklist covering scope, exclusions, testing, handover, milestones, assumptions, portfolio evidence and risks. It is an indicator and flag source, not part of the default 100-point score.

EVA-007 - Why proposal quality is evaluated separately

Proposal quality describes how complete and checkable a proposal is. It is different from freelancer skill, price and deadline. A complete proposal makes the other criteria easier to verify; an incomplete one lowers the confidence of the comparison.

EVA-007 - Proposal completeness checklist

#	Item	Pass condition	Where checked
1	Scope mapped to job requirements	Each requirement of the job has a stated approach	Proposal text
2	Exclusions stated explicitly	Items not included are listed, even if the list is 'none'	Exclusions section
3	Testing included	Testing and defect-fixing hours are included or an add-on price is given	Estimate breakdown
4	Deployment and handover included	Deployment and handover hours are included	Estimate breakdown
5	Milestones tied to deliverables	Each milestone has a date, a deliverable and a payment share	Milestone plan
6	Assumptions stated	Client dependencies and assumptions are listed	Assumptions section
7	Relevant portfolio references	At least one cited project overlaps with the job's skills	Portfolio references checked against case studies
8	Risks acknowledged	At least one realistic risk and its effect on the schedule is stated	Risk statement

Proposal completeness = items passed / 8. In the default framework this value is NOT part of the 100-point overall score; it is shown as a quality indicator and as flags. A platform may add it as a sixth criterion and renormalize weights (EVA-005).

EVA-007 - Interpretation rules

- 6 to 8 items passed: complete enough to compare directly.
- 4 to 5 items passed: compare with caution and ask the freelancer to supply the missing items.
- 0 to 3 items passed: low-confidence comparison; do not rank as if equivalent to complete proposals.
- A missing item is a missing-information signal, not proof of poor skill or bad intent (EVA-006).

EVA-007 - Quality of scope and estimate

- A good estimate shows hours by work package and states what is excluded.
- A price far below the reference with no testing or deployment hours is not comparable to a full-scope price (EVA-002).
- A duration shorter than the reference needs capacity support (EVA-003).
- Milestone payments tied to deliverables reduce client risk; a large upfront share (above 50 percent) is flagged.

EVA-007 - Quality of evidence cited in the proposal

- Project IDs cited must exist and must list the freelancer as a contributor.
- Claims without a project ID are unsupported claims (EVA-001).
- Overstated attribution of team work is an inconsistency flag (QUA-006).

EVA-007 - Examples from the synthetic dataset (computed)

Lowest completeness in the 30 synthetic proposals: PRP-004 with 4 of 8 items passed; failed items: Testing included, Deployment and handover included, Assumptions stated, Risks acknowledged. Highest: PRP-030 with 8 of 8. Distribution of passed items across the 30 proposals: 4 items: 2 proposals; 5 items: 1 proposals; 7 items: 4 proposals; 8 items: 23 proposals. These values are also stored in synthetic_dataset.csv as proposal_completeness_items.

EVA-007 - Limitations and uncertainty

The checklist measures completeness, not correctness. A complete proposal can still be unrealistic; use the budget, deadline and evidence criteria for that. Proposal length and writing style are not quality indicators and must not be rewarded.

EVA-007 - Summary of key findings

- Proposal completeness = items passed / 8.
- Incomplete proposals lower comparison confidence; they do not prove incompetence.
- Length and writing style are not quality indicators.

EVA-007 - Keywords and alternative terminology

proposal quality; completeness checklist; proposal review; scope clarity; exclusions; milestones; assumptions; risk statement; bid quality

5. QUA-004: QUA-004 Client Review Interpretation Guide

Source document ID: QUA-004 | Data status: Factual guidance on quality indicators with synthetic (fictional) examples clearly labelled

Purpose and scope: explain how to read client reviews and ratings fairly, how the reputation criterion is computed, and how to treat small samples, conflicting feedback, old reviews and unrelated reviews.

QUA-004 executive summary

Reviews are subjective evidence with useful specific observations and unreliable vague ones. A small number of reviews gives uncertain estimates, missing reviews are not negative, and no technical incompetence should be inferred from one review.

QUA-004 - Specific versus vague feedback (fictional examples)

Review ID	Type	Text	Interpretation
REV-007	Specific, positive	Order list query dropped from about 1.8 s to 0.4 s after the index change	Supports FRE-003 database tuning evidence; check consistency with PRJ-001.
REV-011	Specific, positive	Citations traced to the right passages in 58 of 60 evaluation questions	Supports FRE-004 RAG evidence; consistent with PRJ-004.
REV-017	Mixed, specific	Offline conflicts still lose edits in rare cases	Matches documented PRJ-006 limitation; relevant for offline jobs.
REV-006	Vague, subjective	Communication style was not my favourite	No observable fact; low weight.
REV-018	Vague, negative	Not what I imagined. Felt slow.	No project detail; do not infer incompetence.

QUA-004 - Handling small samples

With few reviews, one rating shifts the average strongly. The reputation score shrinks the average toward a neutral prior of 60 with a strength of 3 pseudo-reviews: score = (n x base + 3 x 60) / (n + 3), where base = (mean rating - 1) / 4 x 100. Example: FRE-002 has 3 reviews (5, 5, 3): mean 4.33, base 83.3, score = (3 x 83.3 + 180) / 6 = 71.7. This protects against over-reacting to few ratings. When there are zero reviews, the criterion is marked missing and the weights are renormalized; it is never scored as 0.

QUA-004 - Conflicting feedback

When reviews disagree, report both and look for specifics. For example FRE-006 has REV-016 (4 stars, notifications arrive within seconds) and REV-018 (2 stars, vague). The specific review has more evidential value.

QUA-004 - Outdated and unrelated reviews

- Reviews older than about 3 years carry less information about current skills; show the date and avoid hiding them.
- Reviews about a different type of work (for example a design job when evaluating a backend job) should be shown but not used as evidence for the current technical skills.
- Reviews about price disputes or personality contain no technical information.

QUA-004 - Bias and fairness

Reviews can reflect client expectations, language differences or personal preference. Do not use review text mentioning protected or irrelevant personal characteristics. Treat extremely short comments as low-information.

QUA-004 - Rules for the recommendation assistant

- Quote review IDs when using review content.
- Never infer technical incompetence from a single negative review.
- Never treat missing reviews as a negative rating.
- State the number of reviews with every reputation statement.

QUA-004 - Summary of key findings

- Specific reviews carry more weight than vague ones.
- Reputation score shrinks toward a neutral prior for small samples.
- Missing reviews mean missing data.

QUA-004 - Keywords and alternative terminology

client reviews; ratings; reputation; review bias; small sample; Bayesian shrinkage; feedback; testimonial; outdated review

6. QUA-005: QUA-005 Delivery and Deadline Performance Indicators

Source document ID: QUA-005 | Data status: Factual guidance on quality indicators with synthetic (fictional) examples clearly labelled

Purpose and scope: define measurable delivery indicators and how to interpret delivery records in context.

QUA-005 executive summary

Delivery reliability is measured from records such as milestones on time, schedule variance and post-release defects. These records must be read together with scope changes and dependencies before drawing conclusions.

QUA-005 - Measurable indicators

Indicator	Definition	Example (illustrative record)
Schedule variance	(actual weeks - planned weeks) / planned weeks	DEL-007 (FRE-003, PRJ-002): (24 - 18) / 18 = 33 percent
Milestone punctuality	Milestones on time / total milestones	DEL-013 (FRE-005, PRJ-005): 4 of 6
Post-release defects	Defects reported after acceptance for the component	DEL-014 (FRE-006, PRJ-006): 3
Scope-adjusted variance	Variance after removing approved scope changes	Needs change log (EST-006)

QUA-005 - Interpreting records

DEL-007 shows a 33 percent schedule variance, but PRJ-002 had a client-driven change to escrow rules, so the variance is not a clean measure of the freelancer's reliability. DEL-003 (FRE-003 in PRJ-001) shows 1 week late on 14 planned weeks (7 percent) and 5 of 6 milestones on time. Different projects have different baselines and should not be compared without context.

QUA-005 - Small number of records

With one to three records, averages are unstable. State the number of records, avoid ranking freelancers on punctuality alone, and do not treat a freelancer without records as unreliable.

QUA-005 - Measured records versus opinions

Type	Definition	Example (fictional)
Documented fact	Observable, verifiable record	Milestone 3 delivered 2 days after the agreed date (record DEL-007).
Measured indicator	Quantified from a record or tool	Illustrative line coverage 71 percent in PRJ-001.
Subjective opinion	Personal impression without a checkable basis	'Felt slow' (REV-018).

QUA-005 - Linking to proposals

A proposal's promised duration is evaluated using capacity and reference duration (EVA-003). History is a supporting signal: it can raise attention to risk but does not make a deadline infeasible by itself.

QUA-005 - Evidence requirements and uncertainty

Delivery claims need a record ID. Without records: 'no delivery record found'. Do not guess punctuality from reviews.

QUA-005 - Summary of key findings

- Schedule variance and milestone punctuality are measurable.
- Context such as scope change must accompany late records.
- Few records give weak evidence.

QUA-005 - Keywords and alternative terminology

delivery; milestones; schedule variance; on-time delivery; deadline performance; late delivery; reliability record

7. QUA-006: QUA-006 Professional Conduct and Collaboration Standards

Source document ID: QUA-006 | Data status: Factual guidance on quality indicators with synthetic (fictional) examples clearly labelled

Purpose and scope: define observable professional conduct indicators such as disclosure of limitations, honoring agreements and respectful handling of disagreement, and how to avoid unfair inference.

QUA-006 executive summary

Professional conduct is assessed through documented behavior: disclosing known issues, accurate scope statements, honoring payment and milestone terms and respectful disagreement. Allegations without evidence are not facts.

QUA-006 - Observable conduct indicators

- Discloses known defects and limitations at handover (FRE-003 disclosed the PRJ-002 reconciliation mismatch).
- States exclusions and assumptions in proposals.
- Documents decisions and agreed changes.

- Follows the change-control process (EST-006).
- Keeps client data confidential.
- Gives credit to teammates; does not claim team work as individual work.

QUA-006 - Honest attribution

A proposal or profile that claims sole implementation of a team deliverable is an attribution risk. Example: PRJ-001 CI/CD was authored by FRE-005; a claim by another freelancer to have built the pipeline would conflict with the case study and must be flagged as inconsistent evidence.

QUA-006 - Handling disputes

Disputes require records from both sides. A single complaint is a signal, not a finding. Misconduct statements require documented platform decisions; otherwise the assistant must not state them as facts.

QUA-006 - Examples (fictional)

- Positive: FRE-005 in PRJ-005 explained why the stateful service stayed on a virtual machine and documented the risk, rather than hiding it.
- Negative (fictional): a freelancer agrees to a fixed milestone, changes the scope without notice and delivers fewer features; the change log shows no approval. This is a documented conduct issue.
- False positive: a client reports 'unprofessional' after a deadline moved due to the client's own late approvals; the records show client-side delay.

QUA-006 - Fairness constraints

Do not use protected or irrelevant personal characteristics such as nationality, gender, age, religion, appearance or accent. Conduct is judged only from work-related records.

QUA-006 - Evidence requirements and uncertainty

Conduct statements need a record ID or document reference. If none exists the answer is 'no conduct information in the knowledge base'.

QUA-006 - Summary of key findings

- Conduct is evidenced by disclosure, attribution and records.
- A single complaint is not misconduct.
- Personal characteristics are excluded.

QUA-006 - Keywords and alternative terminology

professional conduct; ethics; honesty; disclosure; dispute; attribution; confidentiality; misconduct; fairness

8. Summary of key findings

- EVA-006: Risk signals prompt review; they do not prove failure or misconduct.
- EVA-007: Proposal completeness = items passed / 8.
- QUA-004: Specific reviews carry more weight than vague ones.
- QUA-005: Schedule variance and milestone punctuality are measurable.
- QUA-006: Conduct is evidenced by disclosure, attribution and records.

9. Keywords and alternative terminology

proposal risk; fairness; bias; false positive; risk indicator; uncertainty; missing information; protected characteristics; client judgement; explainability; audit; proposal quality; completeness checklist; proposal review; scope clarity; exclusions; milestones; assumptions; risk statement; bid quality; client reviews; ratings; reputation; review bias; small sample; Bayesian shrinkage; feedback; testimonial; outdated review; delivery; schedule variance; on-time delivery; deadline performance; late delivery; reliability record; professional conduct; ethics; honesty; disclosure; dispute; attribution; confidentiality; misconduct